

Flatscreens

Internet, Integration, Inspiration And More

There is a lot happening in the flat screen displays space—new technologies for power saving, improved life, integration with other devices, Internet connectivity, eco- and eye-friendliness and more. Here are the key tech trends and innovations



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During the initial months infants are clueless about two-dimensional (2D) objects. When they slowly start focusing and seeing things, they assume everything to be three-dimensional (3D). That is the reason why they try to grab everything they see—even if it is only a picture in a magazine. At our age we definitely know the difference between 2D and 3D, yet the current flat screen displays can easily fool us—all thanks to the fast evolving and dynamic display technologies that they use.

Flat screens are in vogue today, both for TVs and computer monitors.

"The flat screen TV market is growing rapidly. The expected market of 2009 is close to 2 million, which is expected to double during 2010. Even the smaller sizes are gaining volumes because of the transition of cathode ray tube (CRT) TV consumers to flat screens," explains Panasonic spokes-

person. "Another customer preference driving this category is connectivity and convergence of various digital devices into one. Customers prefer highly convenient products such as those that enable pictures clicked by a digital camera to be viewed directly on a liquid crystal display (LCD) TV by inserting a secure digital card (SD card) into the TV, thereby making the operations wireless," he adds.

Naved Chaudhary, head-marketing, Intex Technologies, presents interesting figures regarding the market for computer monitors: "The total market for monitors stood at Rs 45,030 million approximately in the financial year 2008-09. This amounts to about 6.6 million units. The ratio of LCD to CRT stood at around 80:20 (as per IDC)."

Out of 6.6 million units sold, around 4.8 million units were LCD monitors. "As far as the size is concerned, 38cm and 41cm LCDs are gradually phasing out. The 43cm and

48cm monitors are emerging as the favourites, especially amongst the students, small office-home office users and small and medium enterprises. Bigger screens like 51cm and 58cm, and even bigger ones are catching up in niche segments like the affluent upper-middle class, gaming enthusiasts, etc. Odd sizes like 40cm and 47cm are also emerging," he adds.

Innovation is a good vicious cycle. A product segment that sees innovations gains a large market share. And once a product sees customer support, the industry innovates to make it better. The case with flat screens is no different.

Here we highlight the innovations swaying the market globally so that you know what features to look for when you buy one for yourself.

LED leads to success

"The advent of light-emitting diodes (LED) technology could be counted as one of the major innovations in the